

School of Computing and Information Systems

ISYS90045 Professional Skills in IS Consulting

End of Semester 2 2019

Reading Time: 15 minutes

Writing time: 120 minutes

This paper has 5 pages including this page.

Authorised Materials

Dictionaries: Paper based language translation dictionaries are permitted provided they are not annotated in any way.

Instructions to Invigilators

- The examination paper MAY NOT BE TAKEN from the examination room
- Students are to be provided with 1 script book
- Provide extra script books on request

Instructions to Students

- The total marks for this examination is 40
- Ensure your student number is written on all script books during writing time
- The examination consists of 6 questions. Some questions have multiple parts.
- You should answer FOUR 4 questions. Each question is worth 10 Marks.
- Answer all questions on the right-hand lined pages of the script book
- Start the answer to each question on a new page in the script book
- The left-hand unlined pages of script books are for notes and will not be marked
- Write legibly in blue or black pen or pencil
- Mobile phones, tablets, laptops, and other electronic devices, wallets and purses must be placed beneath your desk.
- All electronic devices (including mobile phones and phone alarms) must be switched off and remain under your desk until you leave the examination venue. No items may be taken to the toilet.

Paper to be lodged with Baillieu Library

Q1. Unstructured Problem Solving

Read the following scenario and answer BOTH of the embedded questions: A and B.

Problem solving is the core of what consultants do, there are 2 main types of problems:

- (A) What is the key difference between 'structured' and 'unstructured' problem solving?
(1 Mark)

Your family friend owns a well-known and reputable fast food chain “Pressed for time Pizza” that prides itself on providing customers with fast service and a clean and efficient in-store dining experiences. You’ve eaten there several times yourself with work colleagues as they are open late and you know you can get served quickly and the food is good especially since you need to watch your budget. The main problem is that customers have to go to the restaurant to purchase the pizza and pasta. The owner confides in you that the restaurant sales are in decline – the owner suspects due to the rapid increase and popularity of food delivery services. Just that morning you had nearly been run over by a food delivery motorbike delivering an order to your office. However, your private opinion is that there is now a focus on health and well-being and pizza is not all that healthy. The owner is getting worried and wondering - Should they move into joining the food delivery services and close off their in-store dining? You return to your office after lunch and happen to explain this to your boss, they are sympathetic and allow you two (2) weeks to provide consulting assistance to the restaurant to look at this problem:

- (B) What is the approach to breaking down and solving an unstructured problem taught in this subject that could help you provide a response to the owner of the fast food chain? Please outline each step and the considerations that you need to make. (9 Marks)

Q2. Stakeholder Engagement

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A, B, C and D.

You’ve just been promoted to Manager after a very long and drawn out promotion process. It’s the first day in your new role and the Partner calls to inform you that you are being sent out to see one of his old friends who is now head of International Pharmaceutical Company “IPC”. The Partner and his friend want you to lead a potential purchase of a small laboratory business called BioFuture that IPC is interested in acquiring. The laboratory business that it is interested in specialises in 3D printing and futuristic manufacturing processes of medications which eventually may reduce the cost of manufacturing all medication costs and lead to greater profits. The engagement will focus on answering the question: Should IPC acquire BioFuture?

You know very little about the life sciences or pharmaceuticals industry and have only just met the head of IPC, where do you start?

- (A) How do we define meetings, and why do we have meetings in consulting? How do we establish meeting culture? (2 Marks).

- (B) Good meetings have an agenda. What is an agenda? What tool can we use to create an agenda? Describe its key features. (2 Marks).
- (C) Describe 4 types of interviews and the difference between them including the importance of social cues with each type? (4 Marks).
- (D) Since you are unfamiliar with the engagement describe 4 stakeholders you would interview. Describe which interview type you would choose and why? (2 Marks)

Q3. Engagement Lifecycle

Read the following scenario and answer BOTH of the embedded questions: A and B.

You're a consultant at a Big 4 and have been following a relatively small electronics company called "ECOOL" out of interest in an online hang out. You discover in an online forum that ECOOL is looking to launch a new device worldwide simultaneously to create maximum impact and customer attention as part of a massive expansion strategy. Previously, the company has taken a conservative approach with the products having been launched region by region. This is a massive undertaking as it will require sufficient devices to be made available in each store on the launch date. This is especially challenging as there have been manufacturing constraints and shipping times vary between delivery companies, points which were divulged in the forum. There have been technical problems with the website content: it requires customers to have the latest version of Chrome and doesn't really format correctly on all types of devices – it seems to distort on Smartphone screens in particular. At one point you think to yourself: I wonder if we have the capability to deliver this work?

You can identify a huge opportunity for the consultancy if you were to win this work. You arrive at work and make a time to see the Partner about this potential opportunity, the Partner congratulates you on finding the opportunity and puts you in charge of "winning the work"!

- (A) What are 5 key stages in an engagement lifecycle? (2.5 Marks)
- (B) What key activities do you perform in each stage and how is this relevant to the work you may be undertaking for the electronics company? (7.5 Marks)

Q4. Closing the Engagement and Project Failure

Read the following scenario and answer BOTH the embedded questions A and B:

You're a director at a major IT Consultancy, *Util-IT*. You have several active engagements, and recently your role has shifted to focus on reviewing engagements as they approach their conclusion, and ensuring that all processes and necessary documentation are in order. Typically, these facilitate a viable stream in follow-on engagements.

One day, in the office, your managing Partner asks you why the dedicated account team for Petrochem – your largest Agricorp Client – is sitting idle in the office. You speak to their Senior Manager, Bonnithon Yelp, who says:

“Agricorp wasn't happy with our last set of engagement deliveries – they say we didn't meet the Statement of Work. They stood the team down until they can review it more thoroughly.”

You've seen plenty of situations like this, and you know how to handle them. You ask: “Show me the project's close-out reports.” Bonnithon replies: “What reports...?”

After investigating, you find that Bonnithon has not formally been closing out engagements, they've been failing to meet delivery standards, and clients have been grumbling for some time.

- (A) List five consequences of project failures. (2.5 Marks)
- (B) Bonnithon has been given a list of Reports he should generate at the end of an engagement. List 5, and a description of each. (7.5 Marks)

Q5. Proposals

Read the following scenario and answer BOTH the embedded questions A and B:

You're a member of a pursuit team at a major IT Consultancy, *Qual-IT*. You've been charged with putting together the proposals for a number of potential engagements recently released by a large Manufacturing Corporation – *Arasaka*.

Word has been spreading about a handful of engagements from different sections of the organisation, both the public (Government) and privately (Shareholder) owned. For this reason, the bidding response needs to be different depending on whether it's private or public. Luckily, you're in a position to identify them.

- (A) List five different examples of types of proposals and sales methods you might find when you're responding to both public and private engagements. Provide a basic description for each. (7.5 Marks).

Now that you've identified the kinds of proposals and sales methods at your disposal, you need to decide how to structure them.

(B) List the sections you would expect to see in all types of proposals. (2.5 Marks)

Q6. Risk

Read the following scenario and answer ALL the embedded questions A, B and C:

You work for *Specialised kIT*, an IT Consultancy specialising in high-end technology development, implementation and research support. You are effectively a Research & Development (R&D) Manager for a number of clients, and you're looking to take on a new one as an organisation partner, more than a client.

Today, you have a meeting with, *Biotechnica*, a new company looking to develop a new biofuel source. This project is potentially risky, and there is major competitive research pressure from the traditional fuel sources; and because another part of your firm represents these more traditional Oil and Gas companies, you know it requires some expertise to understand these issues. So, you meet with them to discuss their problems, needs, and the services your firm can provide.

You swipe into a secure area with your client access pass and ask them to show you the server room. You are informed that the cloud company uses a cloud solution to avoid having any onsite data centres; any employee who needs access to a cloud service can buy it on their company card.

As you learn more about the company, it becomes clear a thorough risk assessment will be needed.

(A) Define Risk. (1 Mark)

(B) What are the five primary ways of managing risk? Provide a short definition of each. (5 Marks)

(C) Identify and discuss 4 Risks in the client notes. Explain why you think they are risks and describe their inherent consequences. (4 Marks)

=====END OF EXAM=====